

Muhammad Afzaal

IT Support & Systems Administrator | Microsoft Azure, Entra ID, Windows & Linux

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SUMMARY

IT professional with two years as the sole technical contact for multiple small-business clients, supporting users, accounts and access, business email, devices, DNS, and cloud-hosted systems from first report through resolution. Hands-on with Microsoft Azure, Entra ID, Windows Server, Ubuntu Linux, and PowerShell automation, with a strong networking and security foundation. B.S. in Information Technology; CompTIA A+, Network+, and Security+ certified, and Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104) certified.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Identity: Microsoft Azure (Virtual Machines, App Service, VNets, Storage, Monitor), Entra ID, user and access provisioning, least-privilege access

Systems: Windows Server, Ubuntu Linux, IIS, Nginx, MariaDB, managed disks, snapshots, backup and recovery, persistent Linux storage (UUID/fstab)

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, CIDR/subnetting, routing, ports/protocols, firewall rules (NSGs), VNet peering, load balancing, NAT, connectivity troubleshooting

Scripting & Automation: PowerShell (Azure PowerShell), Bash, Azure CLI, GitHub

Support & Security: End-user support, business email administration, device-related support, domain and DNS management, TLS enforcement, ITIL practices, documentation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance IT & Cloud Support Specialist

May 2024 - Present

Self-Employed | Brooklyn, NY

- Serve as sole technical contact for multiple small-business clients, owning issues from first report to resolution across user accounts, email, devices, domains, and cloud-hosted services.
- Provision user accounts and access, administer business email for client staff, and resolve account, login, and device-related issues directly with users.
- Provisioned and managed an Azure Windows VM for a client workload with snapshots and a secondary VM for disaster recovery; hosted and maintained a client website on Azure App Service.
- Managed domain transfers, DNS records, and nameservers across client accounts, resolving availability and connectivity issues.
- Gather requirements and explain technical changes in plain language to non-technical clients.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Azure Segmented Network Infrastructure | [GitHub](#)

- Built two peered VNets with private Linux VMs across web, API, and database subnets, secured with NSGs and Azure Bastion, plus Load Balancer, Private DNS, and NAT Gateway.
- Validated connectivity over DNS, TCP/80, TCP/8080, and TCP/3306, and diagnosed NSG priority, routing, and peering failures using Network Watcher, Azure CLI, curl, and nc.

Azure Multi-OS Compute Infrastructure | [GitHub](#)

- Deployed and administered Windows Server (IIS) and Ubuntu (Nginx) VMs; configured Azure Monitor alerting and verified recovery by restoring data from a snapshot-based disk.

Azure Storage and PowerShell Lab | [GitHub](#)

- Wrote and debugged Azure PowerShell automation scripts, including short-lived user delegation SAS tokens for least-privilege access; enforced TLS and lifecycle management across Blob Storage and Azure Files.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA A+ | CompTIA Network+ | CompTIA Security+ | ITIL Foundation

Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104) | Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) | AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner

EDUCATION

B.S. Information Technology - Western Governors University | 2026

A.A.S. Computer Information Systems (IT Support) - Oakland Community College | 2024